Proposal triage: evidence before ranking

Syed Jawad Shah | MATACS-TH-2026-02 | Configurable criteria; human award

H Human checkpoint

R Rules / ordinary code

AI AI extraction

H | Admin configuration

Set category, fact definitions, gates, weights, scales and dates.
Validate and publish an immutable criteria version.

H | Upload and choose category

Reviewer uploads; code scans files and retains source hashes.

R | Text extraction

PDF text / OCR; preserve source IDs and page locations.

AI | Candidate fact extraction

Extract twice at temperature 0 using identical inputs and configuration.
Use generic prompt + admin definitions; return facts and evidence.
Return nulls and warnings; ignore and log embedded instructions.

R | Validate candidate facts

Compare both outputs, including evidence. Flag differences for human review.
Matching outputs can still be wrong.
Check schema, sources, units, dates and contradictions.

CLARIFY / alert

Corrected evidence -> VALIDATE

H | Flagged / clarify

Missing facts, D timeline
or C security alert.
No rank until resolved.
Any provisional score is clearly
labelled and excluded from ranking.
Obtain evidence; log corrections.
C earns no bonus or penalty.

Fact edit

Valid facts

CLARIFY

R | Mandatory checks

Bidder-held licence + number, WSIB, insurance;
price <= CAD 260,000; completion <= 16 weeks from award.

FAIL

R | Ineligible

Demonstrated mandatory failure.
B: future subcontractor does not
satisfy bidder-held licence rule
on submitted evidence; this is
not proof B has no licence.
Score null; rank null.

PASS

H | Review before release

Validate evidence and optional omissions; clear security alerts.
Fact edits return to validation; no silent requirement waivers.

Approved; no open flags

R | Score and rank

Released results only for reviewed, eligible proposals.
Frozen facts + criteria version; deterministic scores and audit.

H | Final human award decision

Human records decision, reasons and any authorized exception.
Policy changes use a new version applied to every proposal.

Corrections and clarifications repeat validation and mandatory checks before released scoring.

Exceptions need separate authorization, reasons, evidence and original/revised results; no silent gate bypass.

C's provisional score is an illustrative sample calculation, not a released ranking.

Sample assumptions: A and E are ranked assuming their five-year experience counts are validated. C remains flagged with rank null and an illustrative provisional score of 42.66, pending human clearance of its embedded instruction and validation of assumed facts.